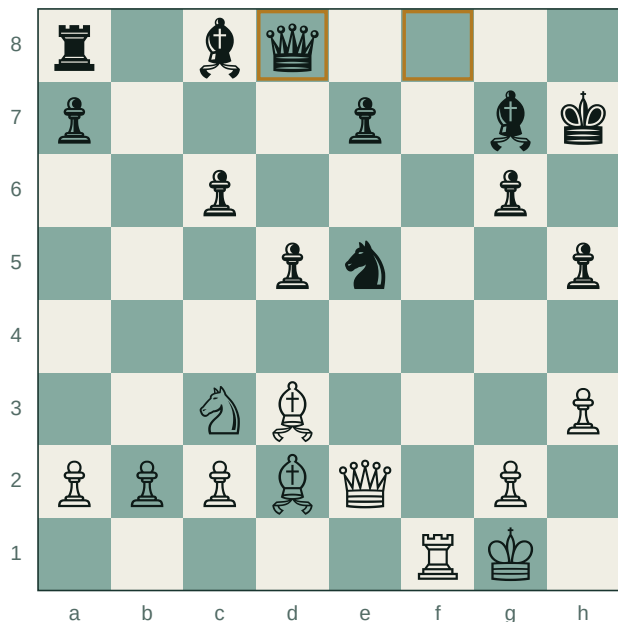


Pins and pressure: White, move 18

Pins and pressure

White to move



Previous move: 17...Qd8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

18. Qxh5+ Kg8 19. Bxg6 Nxg6 20. Qxg6

18.Qxh5+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From h5 it attacks king on h7 and knight on e5. Recorded reply: **18...Kg8**.

19.Bxg6 The bishop captures the pawn on g6. Recorded reply: **19...Nxg6**.

20.Qxg6 The queen captures the knight on g6.

At the end, nominal material is White 25 / Black 24 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +2: the balance goes from -1 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on h7. Absolute pin: pawn on g6.